



PYRAMID DEBATE

Pyramid Discussion

A pyramid discussion is a speaking task where you start alone, and form progressively larger groups, eventually involving the whole class by the end.

Stage 1: Work alone (1 student)

Stage 2: Pairs (2 students)

Stage 3: Small group (4 students)

Stage 4: Large group (8 students)

Stage 5: Whole class

Pyramid Debates

Your question is: **Which three skills are the most important for an international student at LSE?**

Through each stage, you need to discuss, argue, persuade and **agree** on three skills. By the end of the lesson, the whole class will agree on the final three.

Your tutor will guide you through the stages: ideally when forming pairs, you'll have at least one answer in common to make things easier. The skills are on the next slide.

Which three skills are the most important for an international student at LSE?

1. Perfect pronunciation
2. Speaking accurately, but slowly
3. Speaking fluently, but inaccurately
4. Presentation skills
5. Reading for general meaning (quick)
6. Reading for key points (slow)
7. Able to locate useful sources quickly
8. Understanding lectures
9. Understand different accents
10. Working alone
11. Working with other students
12. Participating in seminars
13. Learning from feedback
14. Networking with others for future opportunities
15. Accuracy with written language
16. Accuracy with written structure